

## DIAGNOSTIC TESTING

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This diagnostic test helps to determine whether people taking the test harbor illusions of control.

### Illusion of Control Bias Test

**Question 1:** When you participate in games of chance that involve dice—such as backgammon, Monopoly, or craps—do you feel most in control when you roll the dice yourself?

- a. I feel more in control when I roll the dice.
- b. I am indifferent as to who rolls the dice.

**Question 2:** When returns to your portfolio increase, to what do you mainly attribute this turn of events?

- a. The control that I've exercised over the outcome of my investments.
- b. Some combination of investment control and random chance.
- c. Completely random chance.

**Question 3:** When you are playing cards, are you usually most optimistic with respect to the outcome of a hand that you've dealt yourself?

- a. A better outcome will occur when I am controlling the dealing of the cards.
- b. It makes no difference to me who deals the cards.

**Question 4:** When and if you purchase a lottery ticket, do you feel more encouraged, regarding your odds of winning, if you choose the number yourself rather than using a computer-generated number?

- a. I'm more likely to win if I control the numbers picked.
- b. It makes no difference to me how the numbers are chosen.

### Test Results Analysis

**Question 1:** People who feel more confident rolling the dice themselves, rather than allowing someone else to roll, are more likely to be susceptible to illusion of control bias.

**Question 2:** People who feel that they are able to exert control over their investments are likely to be susceptible to illusion of control bias.

**Question 3:** Question 3 parallels Question 1. People who perceive that they have more control over the outcome of a hand of cards when dealing the cards themselves are likely to be susceptible to illusion of control bias.